



LIVING THINGS

You are a living thing. All living things are made up of cells, and your body is made up of many billions of cells. Your cells join together to make tissues, for example muscles. Tissues combine to make organs, such as your heart. Biologists are scientists who study living things. They have divided the world of living things into groups called “kingdoms.” The study of plants is called botany, and the study of animals is called zoology.



Cherries



Seaweed



Moss



Fly agaric fungus

Bacteria and fungi kingdoms

Bacteria are so tiny they can't be seen without a microscope. They have a simple, one-cell structure. Bacteria and fungi feed on other living things and recycle the remains.

Splitting up

Living things are made up of at least one cell. For a living thing to reproduce and grow, its cells must keep on splitting into identical pairs. This single-cell bacterium divides every 20 minutes. Look how many bacteria there are after one hour.



Now



20 minutes later



40 minutes later



One hour later

All living things make copies of themselves. This process is called reproduction.

Living things all find some way of breathing. A cat breathes through its nose.

Living things need food to stay alive.